This is a simple and efficient way to access your system logs without needing an SSH connection. Note that it will take several minutes for a log message to appear in the log viewer.

3.2.2 Monitoring the load of a virtual machine

AWS can help you answer another question: is your virtual machine close to its maximum capacity? Follow these steps to open the EC2 instance's metrics:

1. Go to EC2 in the AWS Management Console: https://console.aws.amazon.com/ec2/.
2. Open the list of all virtual machines by choosing Instances from the subnavigation options.
3. Select the running virtual machine by clicking the row in the table.
4. Select the Monitoring tab in the lower-right corner.
5. Click the three dots at the upper-right corner of the Network in (Bytes) metric and choose Enlarge.

You'll see a graph that shows the virtual machine's use of incoming networking traffic, similar to figure 3.18, with metrics for CPU, network, and disk usage. As AWS is looking at your VM from the outside, there is no metric indicating the memory usage. You can publish a memory metric yourself, if needed. The metrics are updated every five minutes if you use basic monitoring, or every minute if you enable detailed monitoring of your virtual machine, which costs extra.